Vertebral Column

Vertebral column extends from the base of the skull. It protects the spinal cord. It is formed by a number of serially arranged small bones called **vertebrae** (singular : vertebra)

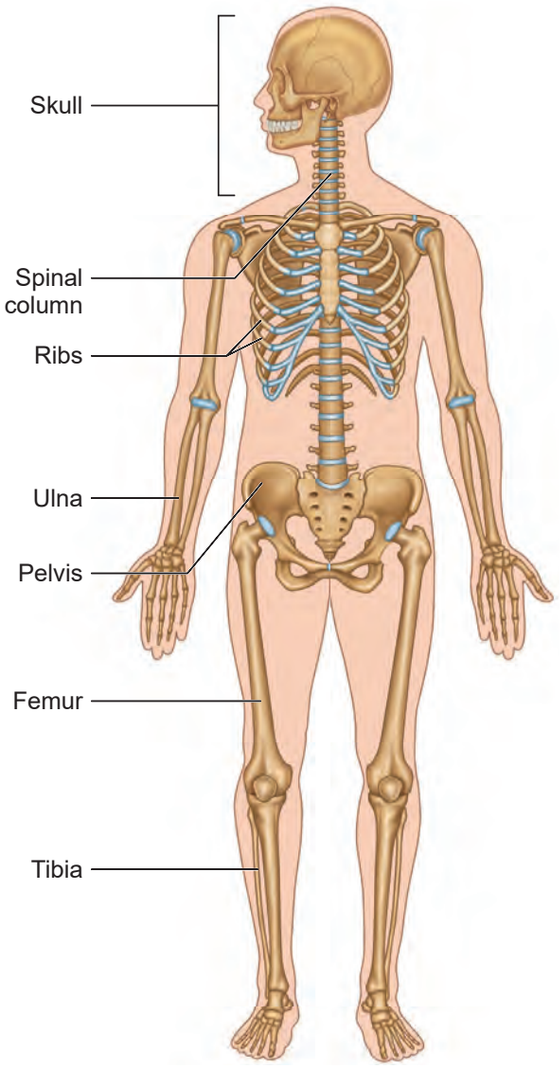
Rib cage

The rib cage is made up of 12 pairs of curved, flat rib bones. It protects the delicate vital organs such as heart and lungs.

Limbs

Man has two pairs of limbs namely upper limbs (fore limbs) and lower limbs (hind limbs). Fore limbs are used for holding, writing etc., while hind limbs are used for walking, sitting etc.,

Skeletal System



Girdles

The fore limbs and hind limbs are attached to the axial skeleton with the help of pectoral and pelvic girdle respectively.

Activity 2: To show that we can bend or move our body only at those points where the bones meet.

Materials required: A wooden scale and string.

Method: Ask your friend to tie a wooden scale and your arm together. So that the elbow is at the centre. Even if you try hard, you cannot bend your elbow.



Conclusion: A single bone cannot bend. The different bones joined together at the elbow, help the elbow to bend.



1.The smallest bone in our body is present inside the ear. It is called **Stapes**. It is only 2.8 millimeters long (average length). The longest bone in the body is the **thigh bone.** (Femur)

2. A new born baby has more than 300 bones. As the baby grow, some bones are joined together, hence the skeleton of an adult has 206 bones.

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